

# FAMILY STUDIES

## OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

# GENERAL FAMILY STUDIES

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# Working With Infants and Young Children, Grade 11

College Preparation

HPW3C

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This course prepares students for occupations involving children from birth to six years of age. Students will study theories about child behaviour and development, and will have opportunities for research and observation and for practical experiences with young children. Students will become familiar with occupational opportunities and requirements related to working with infants and young children. They will also have opportunities to develop research and critical-thinking skills as they investigate and evaluate current research about early childhood education.

**Prerequisite:** None

# A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

## OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to early childhood education, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

## SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

### A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to early childhood education (*e.g., different forms of childcare around the world, strategies for supporting language development in young children*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

**Teacher prompt:** “If you were researching social agencies that support families, what criteria would you use to select agencies?”

### A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information; develop research tools such as surveys or questionnaires*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

**Teacher prompts:** “What are some ways to locate reliable sources of information?” “For which purposes might websites such as Wikipedia be adequate sources of information? What are the risks of relying on websites such as Wikipedia?” “What protocols must be followed to ensure that research involving children is done ethically?”

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, original documents in print, original research published in peer-reviewed journals, data sets from Statistics Canada*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., book reviews, textbooks, websites, newspaper and magazine articles, government reports*)

**Teacher prompts:** “What is the difference between primary and secondary sources in social sciences?” “Why is it important to base your research on a variety of sources rather than just one or two?”

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

### A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

- A3.1** assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice)

**Teacher prompts:** “What strategies can you use to determine the relevance of the information you have gathered?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?” “What values are embedded in these sources?” “Whose voices are represented and whose are absent?” “Whose interests are advanced if you believe the main message of this source?” “What is your own personal connection to the research, and how does this affect your interpretation of the information gathered?”

- A3.2** record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (e.g. notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records)

- A3.3** analyse and interpret research information (e.g., compare information gathered from primary and secondary sources; determine whether similar information is found in different sources)

- A3.4** demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

- A3.5** synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (e.g., determine whether their results support or contradict their hypothesis; weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question)

### A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

- A4.1** use an appropriate format (e.g., oral presentation, written research report, poster, multimedia presentation, web page) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

- A4.2** use terms relating to early childhood education correctly (e.g., social, emotional, cognitive, and physical development; emergent curriculum; play-based approach; natural and logical consequences; running record; anecdotal record)

- A4.3** clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (e.g., generate a reference list in APA style, use in-text author-date citations)

- A4.4** demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

**Teacher prompts:** “How might the research methods you used have affected the results you obtained?” “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

## B. GROWTH AND DEVELOPMENT

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Patterns in Infant and Child Development:** demonstrate an understanding of patterns of social, emotional, cognitive, linguistic, and physical development in infants and children from birth to six years of age;
- B2. Theories of Child Development:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of influential theories about child development;
- B3. Positive Environments for Development:** demonstrate an understanding of how developmentally appropriate environments and experiences promote healthy development in children.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### B1. Patterns in Infant and Child Development

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** demonstrate general knowledge of principles of child development (*e.g., patterns of development are similar around the world, although individual rates of development may vary; child development is multi-determined; child development is holistic; child development is cumulative*)

**Teacher prompt:** “How might you respond to a parent<sup>1</sup> who is concerned that his child is not developing as quickly as other children at the early learning centre?”

- B1.2** identify major milestones in the social, emotional, cognitive, physical, and linguistic development of children from birth to six years of age

- B1.3** explain the interdependence of the social, emotional, cognitive, physical, and linguistic areas of development (i.e., how development in each of the areas affects development in the others)

**Teacher prompts:** “How does the development of language influence a child’s cognitive development?” “How are language development and social development related to each other? How and why might the social development of English language learners in an early education program be different from that of their English-speaking peers?”

- B1.4** describe findings of recent brain research that contribute to our understanding of development in early childhood (*e.g., information about critical periods, brain plasticity, different centres in the brain*)

- B1.5** identify and compare the nutritional and physical-activity requirements of children at different stages between birth and six years of age, based on current recommendations from Health Canada

- B1.6** explain the benefits of healthy eating and physical activity for the learning, growth, and development of young children (*e.g., increased ability to concentrate, fewer common childhood illnesses, increased ability to thrive, reduced long-term risk of heart disease and stroke*)

#### B2. Theories of Child Development

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** outline the theories about child development of major experts in the field (*e.g., Freud, Erikson, Piaget, Bandura, Kohlberg, Vygotsky*)
- B2.2** demonstrate an understanding of the theories about attachment and infant temperament of various child development experts (*e.g., Bowlby, Ainsworth, Thomas and Chess*)

<sup>1</sup> Throughout the Raising and Caring for Children courses, the word “parents” should be understood to refer to parents and guardians. It may also be taken to include caregivers or close family members who are responsible for raising the child.

- B2.3** demonstrate an understanding of how various theories of child development apply to real-life contexts

*Teacher prompt:* “How does attachment theory help an early childhood educator respond to an infant who cries when her parent drops her off?”

### B3. Positive Environments for Development

By the end of this course, students will:

- B3.1** describe the role of educators in an emergent-curriculum approach to early childhood education (e.g., *engaging attentively with children to assess their interests, planning authentic learning opportunities around and beyond the children’s interests*)

*Teacher prompts:* “What are the main differences between an emergent-curriculum approach and a teacher-directed approach to early childhood education?” “How might early childhood educators effectively use an emergent-curriculum approach when working with children with diverse interests?”

- B3.2** explain how environmental factors in the early years influence development later in life (e.g., *influences on later-life health, school performance, socialization, emotional maturity*)

*Teacher prompts:* “What is the impact of Head Start programs on later cognitive development?” “What is the impact of economic privilege on all areas of development?”

- B3.3** describe developmentally appropriate learning environments for children from birth to six years of age

*Teacher prompts:* “What types of activities would promote the social and cognitive development of three-year-olds?” “In addition to activities, what other elements of a learning environment contribute to children’s development (e.g., emotional tone, appropriately sized furniture, reading materials)?”

- B3.4** explain how and why outdoor play contributes to children’s physical and emotional health (e.g., *by providing opportunities for vigorous exercise and connection with the natural environment, by laying the foundation for a healthy lifestyle in the future*)

- B3.5** explain the ways in which the development of infants and children is connected to the well-being of their families and the society in which they live (e.g., *through access to social supports; access to educational and employment opportunities; access to adequate health care; access to affordable, high-quality childcare*)

- B3.6** describe strategies early childhood educators can use to promote healthy eating among young children from birth to six years of age (e.g., *encouraging mothers to store expressed breast milk at the childcare centre, modelling healthy eating, offering a variety of nutritious food choices, creating opportunities for children to grow food*)

*Teacher prompt:* “What kind of snacks can you have children help prepare? How could this encourage healthy eating?”

## C. EMPLOYMENT OPPORTUNITIES AND REQUIREMENTS

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Education and Professional Development:** describe postsecondary destinations, workplaces, and professional development opportunities in early childhood education;
- C2. Workplace Expectations:** explain the legal and social workplace expectations for employment in early childhood education in Ontario;
- C3. Essential Skills and Personal Qualities:** demonstrate an understanding of the essential skills, personal qualities, and work habits necessary for success in early childhood education.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### C1. Education and Professional Development

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify various postsecondary pathways leading to employment involving infants and young children
- C1.2** describe a variety of types of childcare (*e.g., home childcare, preschool programs, nannies, drop-in programs, early learning centres, family resource programs*)  
*Teacher prompt:* “How might family needs for childcare differ in urban, suburban, rural, and remote communities? How do these different needs correspond to the availability of different forms of childcare in different settings?”
- C1.3** demonstrate an understanding of the importance of professional development for early childhood educators

#### C2. Workplace Expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** demonstrate an understanding of the responsibilities of early childhood educators as outlined in various local, provincial, federal, and international codes (*e.g., daycare policies, the Ontario Human Rights Code, the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms, the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child*)
- C2.2** describe the legal expectations for ensuring physically safe environments for children in early learning programs (*e.g., fire-safety regulations, food-safety regulations, WHMIS regulations, provisions of the Day Nurseries Act of Ontario*)  
*Teacher prompts:* “How would you position equipment in an early learning centre in order to be in compliance with Ontario fire-safety codes?” “What is ‘lead flushing’ and why does the Day Nurseries Act require all childcare facilities to flush for lead each day?”
- C2.3** identify laws and safety requirements that apply to employees who work with children (*e.g., requirement for a vulnerable sector criminal check, provisions of the Day Nurseries Act of Ontario and the Child and Family Services Act of Ontario*)  
*Teacher prompt:* “Why would a home childcare provider need to know the provisions of the Child and Family Services Act of Ontario?”
- C2.4** identify the responsibilities of early childhood educators in promoting the socialization and healthy development of children (*e.g., providing positive role models; providing a safe environment; fostering environmental awareness; using age-appropriate, accurate information when responding to children’s questions and comments about their bodies; recognizing indicators of mental illness and/or mental health problems; treating all people, including children, equitably regardless of race, ability, sex, or family structure*)



**C2.5** explain the code of ethics and standards of practice as outlined by recognized professional organizations associated with early childhood education in Ontario (e.g., *College of Early Childhood Educators, Canadian Child Care Federation*)

### C3. Essential Skills and Personal Qualities

By the end of this course, students will:

**C3.1** explain how their own personal experiences, beliefs, and attitudes have influenced their attitudes and behaviour towards children (e.g., *experiences, beliefs, and attitudes shaped by family, faith, community, political ideology, socio-economic status*)

**C3.2** describe the personal qualities needed to work with children and families (e.g., *nurturing qualities, empathy, patience, energy, creativity, flexibility*)

**C3.3** describe the essential skills and work habits needed for employment in early childhood education (e.g., *conflict-resolution skills, communication skills, organizational skills, decision-making skills; work habits such as initiative and team-work*)

## D. INTERACTING WITH CHILDREN

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Guiding Children's Behaviour:** demonstrate an understanding of theories and strategies related to child behaviour, and effectively use a range of strategies and skills when working with children from birth to six years of age;
- D2. Developmentally Appropriate Programs and Environments:** demonstrate an understanding of the elements of developmentally appropriate programs and environments for children from birth to six years of age;
- D3. Refining Skills through Practical Experiences:** apply and evaluate their knowledge of child development through practical experiences with children.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### D1. Guiding Children's Behaviour

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** explain the theories about child behaviour and child guidance of various child-development experts (*e.g., Coloroso, Dreikers, Sheedy, Kurcinka*)
- D1.2** describe strategies for encouraging positive behaviour in children from birth to six years of age (*e.g., responding lovingly and reliably to a crying infant, offering choices, discussing natural and logical consequences, setting limits, ignoring negative behaviour*)

**Teacher prompt:** "What are the advantages and disadvantages of offering children choices about what they wear?"

- D1.3** demonstrate the effective use of communication skills and strategies recommended for early childhood educators who are working with children (*e.g., establishing eye contact, listening actively, interpreting body language, using positive statements*)

- D1.4** use a variety of recommended strategies to help children resolve conflicts (*e.g., "I" messages, help with verbalizing feelings, cool-down periods*), and evaluate their effectiveness

**Teacher prompt:** "What are the long-term benefits of helping children to verbalize their feelings?"

#### D2. Developmentally Appropriate Programs and Environments

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** demonstrate an understanding of key strategies and activities that are used in early learning programs to promote the social, linguistic, emotional, cognitive, and physical development of children from birth to six years of age (*e.g., scaffolding, the use of peer helpers*)

**Teacher prompt:** "During your observation day at an early learning centre, what were the three best practices you observed that promote child development? Which area(s) of development did these practices affect?"

- D2.2** describe developmentally appropriate daily routines, schedules, and transitions, and explain why routines and schedules are an important component of a developmentally appropriate early childhood environment

**Teacher prompts:** "Why is it important to include predictable eating and napping times in the daily schedule of an early learning centre?" "How is flexibility built into the daily schedule of infant centres in order to accommodate the needs of infants on different schedules?" "How do predictable transitions reduce stress in an early learning centre?"

**D2.3** explain ways in which a play-based approach to early childhood education promotes social, linguistic, emotional, cognitive, and physical development

**D2.4** explain what infants and toddlers need to prepare them for the development of pre-reading and pre-numeracy skills (*e.g., exploration, sensory stimulation, time and materials to explore and manipulate*)

**Teacher prompt:** “Why would using flash cards be less effective for developing numeracy skills in toddlers than having them use blocks to build a tower?”

**D2.5** demonstrate the ability to plan nutritious snacks and meals for young children (*e.g., plan a one-day menu for an early learning program*)

**Teacher prompt:** “How can you accommodate the needs of children with food allergies or dietary restrictions in an early learning program?”

### D3. Refining Skills through Practical Experiences

By the end of this course, students will:

**D3.1** demonstrate the effective use of a variety of observation techniques to study children (*e.g., running record, anecdotal record, time sample, video, checklist, event sample*)

**D3.2** demonstrate the effective use of strategies and activities to meet the needs of children from birth to age six (*e.g., plan an event for a local daycare or playschool*)

**D3.3** evaluate their experiences of working with children and reflect on their potential strengths and areas for improvement

**Teacher prompts:** “What went well with the activity that you designed and implemented? What did you observe that indicated to you that this would be a meaningful activity for this child/group?” “What skills does this activity help the children develop?” “If you were doing it over again, what might you do differently?”

## E. ADDRESSING SOCIAL CHALLENGES

### OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Issues and Challenges:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of issues and challenges that early childhood educators encounter;
- E2. Neglect and Abuse:** demonstrate an understanding of factors that contribute to neglect and physical, sexual, and emotional abuse and of the roles of early childhood educators in dealing with these issues;
- E3. Social and Cultural Variations:** demonstrate an understanding of how a variety of social and cultural factors affect young children.

### SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

#### E1. Issues and Challenges

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** describe the benefits of and challenges to the development of strong partnerships between early learning programs and their families (*e.g., benefits: families develop confidence and are less likely to feel isolated; children have consistency of environments and expectations; early childhood educators feel more valued and respected; challenges: male early childhood educators may find it difficult to feel trusted; differing values of families and early childhood educators may make it difficult to establish mutual trust or rapport*)
- E1.2** analyse ways in which children become the targets of marketing and the media (*e.g., through licensed products, back-to-school ad campaigns, holiday toy launches, the marketing of gender-stereotyped toys and "child-themed" foods, promotions related to significant days such as Valentine's Day and Halloween, the marketing of electronic devices*)
- E1.3** identify specific challenges early childhood educators face and effective strategies for addressing them (*e.g., strategies for engaging children with exceptionalities, supporting children living in poverty, responding sensitively and appropriately to diverse families*)  
*Teacher prompt: "What strategies could you use to integrate a child who uses a wheelchair into classroom activities that promote social, cognitive, and physical development?"*

- E1.4** identify strategies used for ensuring the safety of children from birth to six years of age in a variety of childcare environments (*e.g., Internet safety education; bullying prevention programs; Stay Alert, Stay Safe programs*)
- E1.5** describe strategies that could be used in early learning programs to reduce their environmental impact (*e.g., using cloth diapers, recycling craft materials, planting a vegetable garden, using reusable cutlery and dishes*)

#### E2. Neglect and Abuse

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** demonstrate an understanding of factors that can lead to neglect or physical, sexual, or emotional abuse (*e.g., a family history of violence, stress, alcoholism*)
- E2.2** identify indicators of neglect and physical, sexual, and emotional abuse (*e.g., unexplained bruising or laceration, withdrawal, unexplained fears*)
- E2.3** demonstrate an understanding that people who work with children have a duty to report and intervene in suspected cases of neglect and physical, sexual, and emotional abuse, and describe prescribed procedures for doing so
- E2.4** describe strategies early childhood educators can use to anticipate and prevent neglect and physical, sexual, and emotional abuse (*e.g., education, communication, policy development*)

### E3. Social and Cultural Variations

By the end of this course, students will:

**E3.1** identify biases in their own points of view and in society about diverse children and families (e.g., biases based on age, ethnicity, faith, language, sex, gender identity, class, ability, status)

**E3.2** identify and evaluate a variety of strategies and activities used in early learning programs to create bias-free environments that support diversity

*Teacher prompts:* “What kind of materials would you select for a playschool in order to support cultural diversity?” “How would you respond if children in your program wanted to play ‘Cowboys and Indians’?”

**E3.3** identify a variety of ways in which family, community, and culture influence young children’s behaviour

**E3.4** describe strategies that can be used in early learning programs to challenge gender stereotypes

*Teacher prompt:* “How might an early childhood educator respond to children who were teasing a boy who plays with dolls?”

**E3.5** explain the role and function of various social agencies that early childhood educators can call on to provide support to families (e.g., children’s aid societies, Dietitians of Canada, police, newcomers’ support centres, family counselling agencies, Native friendship centres)